

1885 ▶ 1895

1885

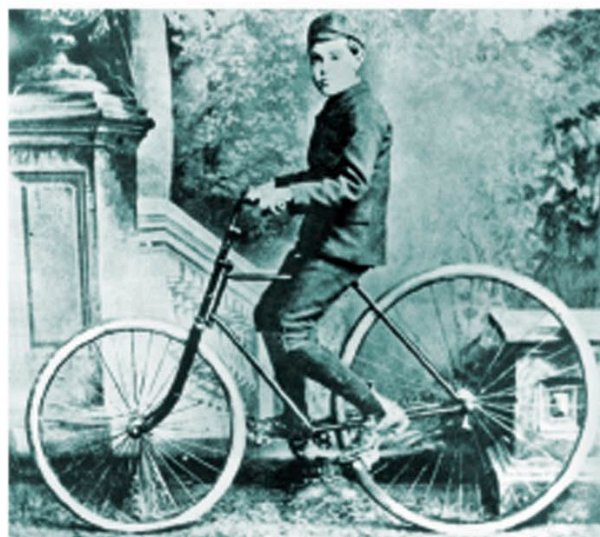
Rabies vaccine

Nine-year-old Joseph Meister became the first person to receive an antirabies vaccine after being bitten by a rabid dog (rabies is a fatal disease passed on by animal saliva). It was French chemist Louis Pasteur who prepared the vaccine. Meister did not develop the disease.



Meister is given the antirabies vaccine under Pasteur's supervision.

Louis Pasteur
See pages 142–143



Dunlop's son on his bicycle with the new tires

1887

Pneumatic rubber tires

Scottish-born John Dunlop, a veterinary surgeon and inventor, cut up an old garden hose, fitted the pieces to the wheels of his son's tricycle, and filled them with air. It gave a much smoother ride, and Dunlop went on to create the first practical pneumatic (air-filled) tires for bicycles. As a result, cycling soared in popularity.



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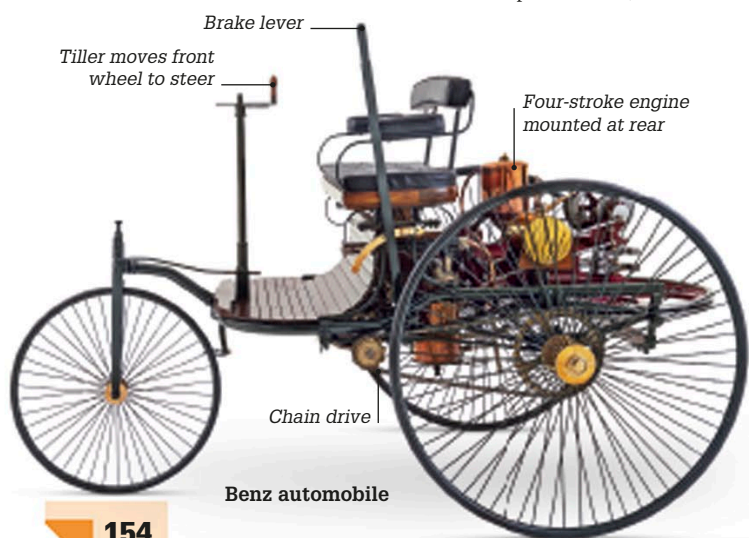
First automobile

German engineer Karl Benz built the first automobile. It had three wire wheels and seating for two, and was powered by a four-stroke engine (see p.148). It reached a top speed of 10 mph (16 km/h) on its first outing.

1886

Radio waves

German physicist Heinrich Hertz carried out a series of experiments to confirm the existence of radio waves, a form of electromagnetic radiation, first predicted by Scottish physicist James Clerk Maxwell in 1867. The hertz (Hz) unit of frequency (the number of cycles per second) is named in his honor.



Benz automobile



Frames from Le Prince's moving picture of traffic on Leeds Bridge

1888

Moving pictures

While staying in Leeds, UK, French photographer Louis Le Prince shot the first moving pictures on paper film using a single-lens camera. The film was never shown in public. Later, in the 1890s, American inventor Thomas Edison developed the Kinetoscope, an early motion picture viewing device.